ISL443E - Project Design and Management

Course Information

- **Institution / Department:** ITU Faculty of Management, Management Engineering Department
- **Semester:** 2026-2027 Fall Semester
- **Course Code and Name:** ISL443E - Project Design and Management
- **Lecturers:** Hür Bersam Sidal (bolat@itu.edu.tr), Nihan Yıldırım (yildirimni@itu.edu.tr)
- **Research Assistant:** Tuğba Yasemin Karagöz (karagozt22@itu.edu.tr)

Course Content:

This course is planned as an entrepreneurship project design and management course that contains all managerial, technical and analytical processes, between the generation of innovative business ideas and the valuation/termination of the business projects.

These phases include conceptual design of the projects, evaluation, selection and feasibility analyses, designing the project organization, planning the project, integrating the processes, directing and implementation of the project activities, analyzing risks, project monitoring, controlling and auditing.

Pre-Class Preparations:

Before each class, all students are responsible of reading and studying the scheduled topics from the Textbook and the supplementary materials provided in Ninova.

Students are expected to develop an initial understanding of each week's topic before the class, and prepare their questions to be discussed in the class for developing their in-depth understanding on the topics.

Also, students can utilize the content of the PMI (Project Management Institute) webinars on project management and agile project management, provided by YouTube channel of ITU Excellence Center (ITU MEM). The webinars can be accessed through the following link:
https://youtube.com/playlist?list=PLoXzn8iuYZxxGWqRjfAyWbxTUUYCoexrM&si=HlnfhXDrmuLd5OK-

TERM PROJECT

- The Term Project will include a detailed project plan preparation for a sustainable entrepreneurial business or social project idea generated by students. Each project must be related and contributing to a *"Sustainable Develeopment Goal (SDGs)"*.
- The team size must strictly be between **7 and 8** members. Teams will be built by students, balanced by the Research Assistant, and must be formed by **October 12, 2026**, via a live Excel document shared by the RA.
- Students must prepare two reports and relevant presentations:
    a) **Project Proposals and Presentation:** Project Selection, Business Model Canvases, Elevator Pitch, draft WBS, Project Organization, Stakeholder Analysis, RACI, team qualifications.
    b) **Final Report and Presentation:** The guideline is available on Ninova, and the report will be submitted nearly in the 14th week.
- **Attendance at the respective presentations is mandatory to receive the presentation grade, and each group member is required to actively participate in the presentation by speaking.**
- The final report will be presented by the teams in the Final Week of the Term and the Final Exam Week. Reports will be uploaded to Ninova by a deadline announced later.
- Project reports must include a complete list of the students who prepared the report on the cover page. There will be no chance to add a name to the report after the assignment is closed on Ninova. No submissions via email will be accepted.
- **Peer evaluation** in project teams will be held after both interim and final presentations.
- ***AI check will be held.*** *"ISL 443E AI Conduct and Declaration" document at Ninova should be signed and submitted additional to the project reports.*

IN-CLASS PRACTICE/CASE STUDIES:

- There will be in-class practice/case studies during the course.
- Participation in these activities requires students to be physically present in the classroom. Only students who are present in class, actively participate in the activity, contribute to the team work, and are listed in the submitted case study report will receive a grade.
- Activities will be completed in student teams formed at the beginning of the class. Teams will be responsible for preparing and submitting a report for the assigned case study through the specific Ninova assignment.
- Once the Ninova assignment closes, no additional names can be added to the report. Submissions via email will not be accepted.
- Students must attend at least 3 out of 5 in-class practices/case studies to earn rational points.

Grading Criteria & General Rules

Component	Weight	Description & Details
Midterm	40%	Evaluates core course concepts and analytical methods.
In-Class Practice / Case Studies	15%	Requires active physical participation in at least 3 out of 5 sessions. *
Term Project	45%	Combined grade for 15% Project Proposal (7.5% presentation + 7.5% report) and 30% Final Report & Presentation (10% presentation + 20% report).

** Only excuses aligned with the **ITU excuse directive** must be presented if exist, to the research assistant.*

- ✓ *As possible changes can occur in the announced activities and the deadlines of the Term Project or Cases, please REGULARLY follow up the announcements and uploads/updates in the NINOVA web site. All course materials and documents will be available in: **www.ninova.itu.edu.tr***
- ✓ *Students are expected to **self-study and practice on MS Project software**.*

Tentative Course Plan

Week	Date	Topic & Activities
Week 1	Oct 1	**Introduction, Entrepreneurship Projects:** Foundations of Project Management, idea generation, creating the business plan, designing the value proposition canvas, and business model canvas.
Week 2	Oct 8	**Project Selection:** Project selection and evaluation, selection criteria, characteristics of selection models, Project Portfolio. *(Business Plan Submission will be expected for the student projects - template provided).*
Week 3	Oct 15	**Project Manager & Project Organization:** Responsibility chart (RACI), Stakeholders Analysis. *In-Class Study 1: Project Selection (scoring models and cost research expected for the student projects).*
Week 4	Oct 22	**Project Planning:** Project Planning (WBS, Project Life Cycle), Scope Management, Introduction to scheduling. *In-Class Study 2: Project Organization, Stakeholder Analysis, RACI, WBS.*
Week 5	Oct 29	**Republic Day Holiday** *(Cumhuriyet Bayramı Tatili)*
Week 6	Nov 5	**Cost Management & Earned Value Management:** Budgeting the Project, Project monitoring and controlling *(cost estimation with cost references will be expected up to week 10). In-Class Practice 3*

Week 7	Nov 12	**Presentation of Project Proposals:** Project Selection, Business Model Canvases, Elevator Pitch, draft WBS, Project Organization, Stakeholder Analysis, RACI, team qualifications
Week 8	Nov 19	**Fall Break** *(Ara Tatil)*
Week 9	Nov 26	**Scheduling in Projects:** PERT/CPM
Week 10	Dec 3	**Scheduling in Projects 2:** Resource Allocation Problem, Resource Levelling, Crashing. In-class Practice 4: Cost/Resource Allocation/Continuation of Week 7.
Week 11	Dec 10	**Risk & Communication Management:** Risk Management and Communication Management in Projects + Guest Speaker.
Week 12	Dec 17	**Agile Project Management:** The need for agility, characteristics of agility, alternative approaches in complex domains. In-class Practice 5
Week 13	Dec 24	**Wrap-Up & Midterm:** Wrap-Up Session, Retrospective & **MIDTERM Exam****.
Week 14	Dec 31	**Final Term Project Presentations 1**
Week 15	Exam Wk	**Final Term Project Presentations 2**

*** Its currently a tentative timeframe to avoid any potential conflicts with pool exams, which are not yet finalized. The exact date and time will be announced on Ninova once confirmed. Please follow the announcements carefully.*

REFERENCES

Textbooks

1. Jack R. Meredith, Scott M. Shafer, Samuel J. Mantel Jr., Margaret M. Sutton; *Project Management in Practice*, 8th Edition, Wiley & Sons Inc, 2020.
2. Jack R. Meredith, Scott M. Shafer, Samuel J. Mantel Jr., *Project Management: A Managerial Approach*, 11th Edition, John Wiley & Sons Inc, 2021.
3. Kerzner, H., *Project management: a systems approach to planning, scheduling, and controlling*, 13th Edition, J. Wiley, 2022.

Additional Resources

- PMI Project Management Body of Knowledge (PMBOK) 6th and 7th Edition.
- PMI-ITU MEM Youtube Channel Content on Project Management – ITU MEM - PMI-TR Webinar Series. https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dRcQXw_UiT0&list=PLoXzn8iuYZxxGWqRjfAyWbxTUUY CoexrM (link to Webinar 1, to Access following Webinars, follow the links in the Channel).